

10 May 2026 18:59:00 ET | 14 pages

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

In-line 1Q26; several positives lie in 2Q26

CITI'S TAKE

PharmaResearch (PR) recorded in-line sales and OP in 1Q26. We expect 2Q26E to also record broadly in line, with upside risk from mgmt. confidence in EU-bound medical device export growth and aggressive expansion in cosmetics segment. Maintain Buy.

In-line 1Q26 — PharmaResearch (PR) recorded in-line sales and OP in 1Q26, with sales of W146bn (+25% YoY) and OP of W57.3bn (+28% YoY). Medical Device sales recorded W80bn (+15% YoY) with positives from better than expected underlying domestic sales upon 400 new accounts increase QoQ while negatives from weak exports due to worse-than expected Japan and slower start in the Middle East. Cosmetics saw strong growth of W42bn (+51% YoY) as PR expanded into SEA region's marketplace followed by China / US Sephora entry. GP margin recorded 77% (+1%p QoQ) despite worse mix (cosmetics sales mix of +3%p increase), which we see as underlying cost efficiency taking place.

2Q26E outlook — We expect PR to record sales of W161bn (+14% YoY) and OP of W65bn heading into 2Q26E (broadly in line with consensus). Mgmt. highlighted for medical device exports to see +25% QoQ growth (in-line with CitiE), with we expect the key driver to come from EU-bound medical device export underpinned by strong end-demand. In addition, PR mgmt. emphasized further growth potential in cosmetics segment, with multiple off / online expansion likely to start in US / EU cosmetic markets as well as increased marketing investment taking place.

Maintain TP —As highlighted in our recent deep-dive note ([PharmaResearch \(214450.KQ\) - Likely unexciting 1Q26E, but is Rejuran really over?](#)), we view PR has multiple growth pillars in the longer term. While we view share price may not appreciate the slowdown in medical device growth, we expect PR's 1) medical device growth to start to accelerate with key markets entry and 2) aggressive growth initiatives in cosmetics to have synergies in further strengthening the brand equity of Rejuran in the longer-term. Thus, we fine-tune our FY26E-28E NP estimates by less than 3%. Reiterate Buy and maintain TP at W480k.

Buy

Price (08 May 26 15:45)	W341,000
Target price	W480,000
Expected share price return	40.8%
Expected dividend yield	1.5%
Expected total return	42.3%
Market Cap	W3,542,870M
	US\$2,424M

Price Performance

(RIC: 214450.KQ, BB: 214450 KS)



Earnings Summary

Year to	Net Profit	Diluted EPS	EPS growth	P/E	P/B	ROE	Yield
31 Dec	(W)	(W)	(%)	(x)	(x)	(%)	(%)
2024A	92	8,838	17.9	38.6	6.6	18.9	0.3
2025A	165	15,801	78.8	21.6	5.1	26.9	1.1
2026E	213	18,395	16.4	18.5	4.1	27.3	1.5
2027E	259	22,366	21.6	15.2	3.3	26.6	1.8
2028E	313	27,068	21.0	12.6	2.7	26.0	2.2

Source: Powered by dataCentral

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

214450.KQ: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: W341,000; TP: W480,000; Market Cap: W3,542,870m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	350	536	674	818	961	PE (x)	38.6	21.6	18.5	15.2	12.6
Cost of sales	-99	-125	-156	-191	-222	PB (x)	6.6	5.1	4.1	3.3	2.7
Gross profit	251	411	518	628	740	EV/EBITDA (x)	23.8	13.1	10.1	7.8	6.3
Gross Margin (%)	71.8	76.7	76.8	76.7	76.9	FCF yield (%)	2.9	4.3	3.3	5.7	7.1
EBITDA (Adj)	135	230	284	349	408	Dividend yield (%)	0.3	1.1	1.5	1.8	2.2
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	38.6	42.9	42.2	42.7	42.4	Payout ratio (%)	12	23	28	28	28
Depreciation	-9	-10	-9	-10	-11	ROE (%)	18.9	26.9	27.3	26.6	26.0
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	Cashflow (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	126	214	267	329	397	EBITDA	135	224	276	339	408
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	36.0	40.0	39.7	40.3	41.3	Working capital	0	-25	-23	-32	-29
Net interest	-16	9	12	13	18	Other	3	-17	-99	-51	-60
Associates	6	0	0	0	0	Operating cashflow	138	183	154	257	318
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	0	-7	0	0	0	Capex	-36	-30	-24	-33	-38
Pre-tax profit	116	217	279	342	414	Net acq/disposals	-170	-113	-7	-9	-12
Tax	-27	-48	-62	-79	-95	Other	-20	-13	0	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	3	-3	-4	-5	-6	Investing cashflow	-226	-156	-30	-42	-50
Reported net profit	92	165	213	259	313	Dividends paid	-10	-12	-39	-53	-65
Net Margin (%)	26.3	30.8	31.6	31.6	32.6	Financing cashflow	183	-15	-39	-53	-65
Core NPAT	92	165	213	259	313	Net change in cash	96	10	85	162	204
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	102	153	130	224	280
Reported EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,395	22,366	27,068						
Core EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,395	22,366	27,068						
DPS (W)	1,100	3,700	5,120	6,220	7,530						
CFPS (W)	13,262	17,527	13,285	22,192	27,532						
FCFPS (W)	9,765	14,683	11,246	19,361	24,207						
BVPS (W)	51,323	66,346	83,489	103,739	128,218						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	10.4	10.5	10.4	10.4	10.4						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	10.4	10.5	11.6	11.6	11.6						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	34.1	53.2	25.7	21.4	17.5						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	36.6	70.1	24.7	23.2	20.4						
Core NPAT (%)	20.2	79.4	28.8	21.6	21.0						
Core EPS (%)	17.9	78.8	16.4	21.6	21.0						
Balance Sheet (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	452	620	766	927	1,131						
Accounts receivables	43	52	60	73	86						
Inventory	57	83	103	125	144						
Net fixed & other tangibles	200	235	247	265	287						
Goodwill & intangibles	33	31	33	37	43						
Financial & other assets	70	22	22	22	22						
Total assets	856	1,044	1,230	1,449	1,713						
Accounts payable	11	11	14	18	21						
Short-term debt	9	8	8	8	8						
Long-term debt	1	0	0	0	0						
Provisions & other liab	265	300	302	302	302						
Total liabilities	286	320	324	328	331						
Shareholders' equity	539	689	867	1,078	1,332						
Minority interests	30	35	39	43	49						
Total equity	569	724	906	1,121	1,382						
Net debt (Adj)	-442	-612	-757	-919	-1,123						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-77.6	-84.5	-83.6	-81.9	-81.2						
For definitions of the items in this table, please click here .											

Figure 1. PR: 1Q26 Results Review

(Wbn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26P	YoY	QoQ	1Q26E Citi	Diff	1Q26E Cons	Diff
Revenue	117	141	135	143	146	25%	2%	145	1%	150	-2%
YoY	56%	69%	52%	39%	25%			24%			
1) By segment											
Medical device (Skinbooster)	69	85	77	83	80	15%	-4%	80	-1%		
Cosmetics	28	31	35	38	42	51%	12%	42	1%		
Pharmaceuticals	17	20	22	23	21	25%	-7%	22	-1%		
Others	2	4	2	(1)	3	26%	-592%	1	152%		
2) By geography											
Domestic	72	90	85	85	88	22%	3%	86	2%		
Exports	45	51	50	58	58	29%	0%	59	-1%		
Asia	32	35	33	37	39	22%	6%	32	21%		
> China	17	18	18	18				14			
> Asia ex-China	15	16	15	19				18			
EU/Oceania	5	7	7	12	10	77%	-18%	12	-20%		
America	6	8	10	9	7	28%	-15%	11	-35%		
Others	2	1	1	1	2	18%	81%	3	-25%		
Operating profit	45	56	62	52	57	28%	10%	55	3%	60	-5%
OPM	38.3%	39.7%	45.7%	36.2%	39.2%			38.3%		40.2%	
YoY	67.7%	81.7%	77.2%	54.1%	28.1%			24.0%			
RP	46	56	65	50	60	31%	21%	58	3%	65	-8%
Ex-minority NP	36	47	49	33	46	28%	43%	45	3%	48	-2%

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

Figure 2. PR: 2Q26 Results Preview

(Wbn)	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26P	2Q26E	YoY	QoQ	2Q26E Cons	Diff
Revenue	141	135	143	146	161	14%	10%	166	-3%
YoY	69%	52%	39%	25%	14%				
1) By segment									
Medical device (Skinbooster)	85	77	83	80	90	6%	13%		
Cosmetics	31	35	38	42	45	45%	6%		
Pharmaceuticals	20	22	23	21	24	17%	12%		
Others	4	2	(1)	3	2	-50%	-26%		
2) By geography									
Domestic	90	85	85	88	94	4%	7%		
Exports	51	50	58	58	67	32%	15%		
Asia	35	33	37	39	39	13%	0%		
> China	18	18	18	-	-				
> Asia ex-China	16	15	19	-	-				
EU/Oceania	7	7	12	10	13	78%	32%		
America	8	10	9	7	13	58%	72%		
Others	1	1	1	2	2	125%	8%		
	0	0	0	0	0				
Operating profit	56	62	52	57	65	16%	13%	68	-4%
OPM	39.7%	45.7%	36.2%	39.2%	40.4%			40.6%	
YoY	81.7%	77.2%	54.1%	28.1%	16.0%				
RP	56	65	50	60	68	21%	13%	73	-7%
Ex-minority NP	47	49	33	46	52	10%	13%	58	-10%

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

Figure 3. PR: Earnings Revision

(W bn, %)	New			Old			%		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	674	818	961	675	820	953	0%	0%	1%
OP	267	329	397	275	338	398	-3%	-3%	0%
RP	279	342	414	286	351	416	-3%	-2%	0%
NP	213	259	313	218	265	314	-3%	-2%	0%
OPM	39.7%	40.3%	41.3%	40.7%	41.2%	41.8%	-1.0%pt	-1.0%pt	-0.5%pt
RPM	41.4%	41.8%	43.1%	42.4%	42.8%	43.7%	-1.0%pt	-1.0%pt	-0.6%pt
NPM	31.6%	31.6%	32.6%	32.3%	32.3%	33.0%	-0.8%pt	-0.7%pt	-0.4%pt

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Source: Citi Research

Bull/Bear: PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

W 570,000
▲ 67% Upside

W 480,000
▲ 41% Upside

W 200,000
▼ 41% Downside



Spread 109pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 08 May 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Stronger-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Higher-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Better cost control management leading to higher margin profile

BASE Assumptions

- Medical device sales growth of +19% YoY in FY26E
- Cosmetics sales growth of +48% YoY in FY26E
- OP margin of 40% in FY26E

BEAR Assumptions

- Weaker-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Lower-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Less effective cost control management leading to lower margin profile

PharmaResearch

Company description

PharmaResearch, founded in 2001, is a leading South Korean medical aesthetics/pharmaceutical company specializing in regenerative materials based on polynucleotide (PN)/polydeoxyribonucleotide (PDRN) ingredients. Its major products include facial injectable medical device Rejuran and arthritis joint cavity injection product Conjuran, followed by derivative value-added cosmetic products under the same Rejuran brand.

Investment strategy

We have a Buy rating on PharmaResearch, a leading company in the global medical aesthetics sector, underpinned by its regenerative PN/PDRN skin booster. Our investment thesis assumes: 1) solid topline growth potential in the domestic market from inbound tourism; 2) increasing penetration in EU/US markets backed by rising brand recognition; and 3) portfolio expansion into toxin, new collagen booster, and EBD providing additional catalysts.

Valuation

Our target price of W480k is based on a P/E methodology. We expect 2026 to be the year when PR's new growth drivers are likely to be fully reflected, underpinned by: 1) full reflection of EU market expansion; 2) increase in penetration among medspas; and 3) EBD and PLLA skin booster potentially entering the global market following their scheduled introduction in Korea within 2025. We believe our target 2026E P/E multiple of 30x is justified, given: 1) brand originality, which many local peers seem to lack, supporting competitiveness and longer product lifecycle; 2) stronger growth potential relative to top-tier peer's injectable aesthetics sales outlook; and 3) significant earnings upside risk from TAM opportunities, with +25%/+35% sales potential in '26E/27E based on our scenario analysis. Our target multiple is set at a 25% premium to PR's broader peer group given the above reasons.

Risks

Key downside risks that could impede the shares from reaching our target price include: 1) change in trend in skin boosters; 2) brand reputation risk in case of medical incidents; 3) rise of generics post-Rejuran's patent expiry after 2030E; and 4) prolonged weak growth in overseas markets.

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Appendix A-1

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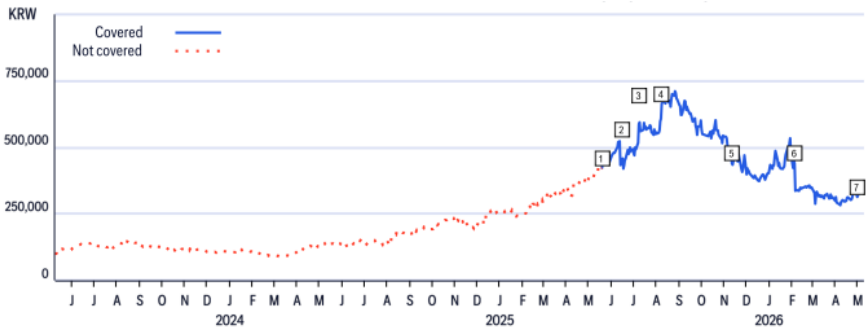
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	19-May-25 04:55:14	*1H	*560,000.00	422,500.00
2	16-Jun-25 02:31:23	1H	*540,000.00	458,000.00
3	08-Jul-25 10:31:21	*1	*710,000.00	588,000.00

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
4	10-Aug-25 17:24:44	1	*800,000.00	664,000.00
5	11-Nov-25 11:50:03	1	*650,000.00	440,000.00
6	04-Feb-26 11:41:01	1	*570,000.00	439,500.00

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
7	30-Apr-26 13:47:42	1	*480,000.00	313,500.00

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	04-Feb-26 06:41:01	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	439,500.00

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
2	06-Mar-26 12:23:25	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	333,000.00

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Data current as of 01 Apr 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	38%	41%	28%	42%	37%	36%

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